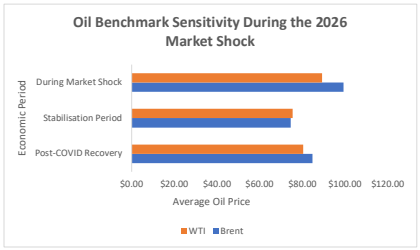
PIVOT ANALYSIS AND BUSINESS QUESTIONS

QUESTION 1: How did global oil prices change across the Post-COVID Recovery, Stabilisation, and Market Shock periods?

Economic Period	Brent	WTI	Grand Total
Post-COVID Recovery	$84.74	$80.22	$82.49
Stabilisation Period	$74.52	$75.40	$74.82
During Market Shock	$99.23	$89.15	$94.16
Grand Total	**$81.54**	**$79.63**	**$80.69**

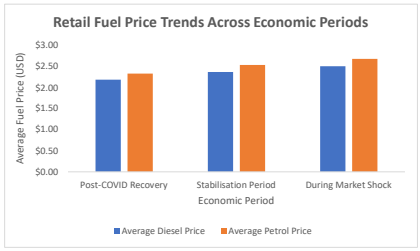


INSIGHT: Average Brent crude prices rose from $74.52 during the Stabilisation Period to $99.23 during the Market Shock, representing a significant increase in energy costs. This indicates that global energy markets reacted strongly to supply uncertainty, increasing costs for businesses and consumers worldwide.

Recommendation: Energy-intensive businesses should implement fuel hedging strategies and diversify energy sources to reduce exposure to future geopolitical disruptions and oil price volatility.

QUESTION 2: How were consumer fuel prices affected during different economic period

Economic Period	Average Diesel Price	Average Petrol Price
Post-COVID Recovery	$2.19	$2.34
Stabilisation Period	$2.38	$2.54
During Market Shock	$2.51	$2.68
Grand Total	**$2.27**	**$2.43**

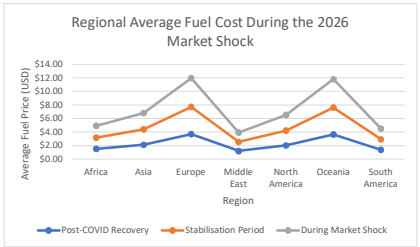


INSIGHT: Both petrol and diesel prices increased steadily across all periods, reaching their highest levels during the Market Shock. Petrol averaged $2.68 per litre, while diesel averaged $2.51 per litre, highlighting the transmission of higher crude oil costs to consumers.

Recommendation: Governments should strengthen fuel pricing policies and encourage investment in alternative energy and public transport systems to reduce the impact of rising fuel costs on households and businesses.

QUESTION 3: Which regions faced the highest fuel cost pressures during the Market Shock?

Region	Post-COVID Recovery	Stabilisation Period	During Market Shock
Africa	$1.53	$1.66	$1.75
Asia	$2.11	$2.29	$2.42
Europe	$3.70	$4.02	$4.25
Middle East	$1.21	$1.32	$1.39
North America	$2.03	$2.21	$2.32
Oceania	$3.65	$3.97	$4.19
South America	$1.39	$1.51	$1.60



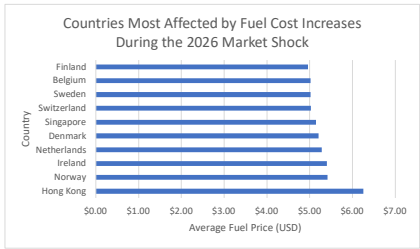
INSIGHT: Europe recorded the highest average fuel price at $4.25 per litre, followed by Oceania at $4.19 per litre. Africa and the Middle East maintained comparatively lower fuel prices. This suggests regional differences in taxation, subsidies, and energy market structures significantly influence consumer fuel

Recommendation: Organizations operating in Europe and Oceania should prioritize fuel efficiency initiatives, optimize transportation networks, and explore renewable energy alternatives to manage rising operating costs.

QUESTION 4: Which countries experienced the highest fuel costs during the Market Shock period?

Period_Category	During Market Shock

Country	Average Fuel Price
Hong Kong	$6.26
Norway	$5.42
Ireland	$5.40
Netherlands	$5.28
Denmark	$5.21
Singapore	$5.15
Switzerland	$5.03
Sweden	$5.02
Belgium	$5.02
Finland	$4.96
Grand Total	**$5.27**

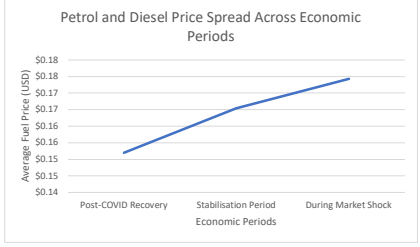


INSIGHT: Hong Kong recorded the highest average fuel price at $6.26 per litre, followed by Norway and Ireland. These countries experienced substantially higher consumer fuel costs than the global average, reflecting taxation policies and dependence on imported energy products.

Recommendation: Countries with exceptionally high fuel prices should evaluate fuel tax structures, expand public transportation infrastructure, and promote energy diversification strategies to improve economic resilience.

QUESTION 5: Did the pricing gap between petrol and diesel widen during the Market Shock?

Economic Period	Average Petrol-Diesel Spread
Post-COVID Recovery	$0.15
Stabilisation Period	$0.17
During Market Shock	$0.17
Grand Total	**$0.16**

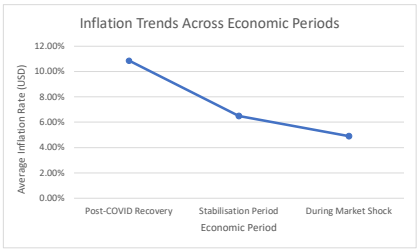


INSIGHT: The average fuel spread increased from $0.15 per litre during Post-COVID Recovery to $0.17 per litre during the Market Shock, indicating that diesel prices experienced relatively stronger upward pressure compared to petrol prices.

Recommendation: Logistics, agriculture, mining, and transport businesses that rely heavily on diesel should implement fuel consumption monitoring systems and improve fleet efficiency to mitigate rising operating expenses.

QUESTION 6: How did inflation behave across the different economic periods?

Economic Period	Average Inflation Rate
Post-COVID Recovery	10.86%
Stabilisation Period	6.50%
During Market Shock	4.90%
Grand Total	**8.99%**

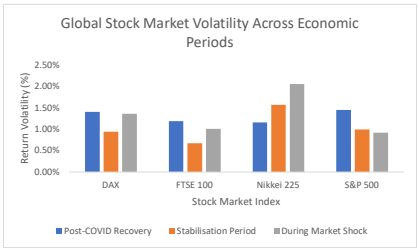


INSIGHT: Average inflation declined from 10.86% during Post-COVID Recovery to 4.90% during the Market Shock period. Despite elevated energy prices, broader inflationary pressures appear to have moderated, suggesting that central bank policies and improving supply chains may have offset some energy-driven inflation risks.

Recommendation: Policymakers should continue balancing monetary policy with supply-side interventions to maintain inflation stability while minimizing the economic impact of future energy market disruptions.

QUESTION 7: Which major stock markets experienced the highest volatility during the Market Shock?

Stock Index	Post-COVID Recovery	Stabilisation Period	During Market Shock	Grand Total
DAX	1.41%	0.95%	1.36%	1.27%
FTSE 100	1.19%	0.67%	1.01%	1.04%
Nikkei 225	1.16%	1.57%	2.06%	1.40%
S&P 500	1.45%	0.99%	0.92%	1.30%
Grand Total	**1.32%**	**1.09%**	**1.44%**	**1.25%**

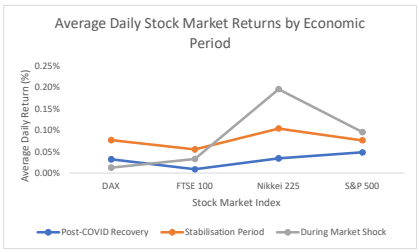


INSIGHT: The Nikkei 225 recorded the highest volatility during the Market Shock with a standard deviation of 2.06%, indicating greater investor uncertainty. In contrast, the S&P 500 showed comparatively lower volatility, suggesting stronger market resilience.

Recommendation: Investors should diversify portfolios across sectors and geographic markets while adopting risk management strategies to reduce exposure during periods of heightened geopolitical uncertainty.

QUESTION 8: How did stock market performance change during the Market Shock period?

Stock Index	Post-COVID Recovery	Stabilisation Period	During Market Shock	Grand Total
DAX	0.03%	0.08%	0.01%	0.05%
FTSE 100	0.01%	0.06%	0.03%	0.03%
Nikkei 225	0.03%	0.10%	0.20%	0.07%
S&P 500	0.05%	0.08%	0.10%	0.06%
Grand Total	**0.03%**	**0.08%**	**0.09%**	**0.05%**

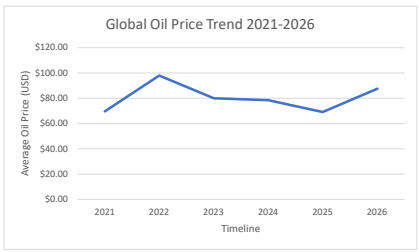


INSIGHT: Average daily returns remained positive across all major indices, with the Nikkei 225 generating the highest average return (0.196%) during the Market Shock. This suggests that while volatility increased, investors continued to identify growth opportunities in certain markets.

Recommendation: Investors should focus on long-term fundamentals rather than short-term market fluctuations, as periods of volatility may still present growth opportunities in resilient markets and sectors.

QUESTION 9: How have oil prices evolved from the Post-COVID Recovery period through the Market Shock?

Timeline	Average Oil_Price
2021	$69.50
2022	$97.92
2023	$80.05
2024	$78.59
2025	$69.14
2026	$87.45
Grand Total	**$80.69**

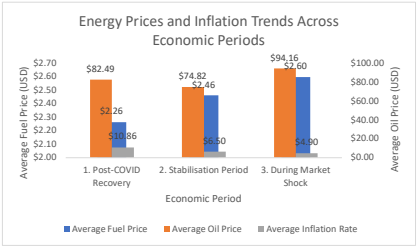


INSIGHT: Oil prices peaked in 2022 ($97.92), declined during 2023–2025, and increased again in 2026 ($87.45). This demonstrates that energy markets remain highly sensitive to geopolitical and supply-side developments even after the initial post-pandemic recovery.

Recommendation: Governments and businesses should continuously monitor geopolitical developments and energy supply risks to improve forecasting accuracy and strengthen preparedness for future market shocks.

QUESTION 10: How did energy prices and inflation evolve across different economic periods?

Economic Period	Average Fuel Price	Average Oil Price	Average Inflation Rate
1. Post-COVID Recovery	$2.26	$82.49	$10.86
2. Stabilisation Period	$2.46	$74.82	$6.50
3. During Market Shock	$2.60	$94.16	$4.90
Grand Total	**$2.35**	**$80.69**	**$8.99**



INSIGHT: Energy prices reached their highest levels during the Market Shock period, while inflation continued to moderate, suggesting broader economic stabilisation despite higher energy costs.

Recommendation: Decision-makers should integrate energy market indicators into economic planning and budgeting processes, as energy price movements remain a key driver of business costs and overall economic performance.

Country	Average Fuel Price
Algeria	$0.14
Angola	$0.53
Argentina	$0.64
Australia	$3.58



Austria	$3.98
Bangladesh	$1.36
Belgium	$4.55
Botswana	$2.31
Brazil	$2.08
Cameroon	$1.37
Canada	$2.95
Chile	$3.37
China	$1.69
Colombia	$1.65
Czech Republic	$3.54
Denmark	$4.72
Ecuador	$0.58
Egypt	$0.18
Ethiopia	$1.43
Finland	$4.49
France	$4.41
Germany	$4.37
Ghana	$2.11
Greece	$4.19
Hong Kong	$5.67
Hungary	$2.20
India	$1.65
Indonesia	$0.91
Iran	$0.04
Iraq	$0.16
Ireland	$4.90
Israel	$4.35
Italy	$4.34
Ivory Coast	$1.43
Japan	$3.54
Jordan	$1.96
Kenya	$2.30
Kuwait	$0.20
Lebanon	$3.22
Libya	$0.06
Malaysia	$0.58
Mexico	$1.01
Morocco	$1.73
Mozambique	$2.48
Myanmar	$0.77
Namibia	$2.41
Nepal	$1.65
Netherlands	$4.79
New Zealand	$4.02
Nigeria	$0.22
Norway	$4.90
Pakistan	$0.73
Peru	$1.80
Philippines	$2.41
Poland	$2.92
Portugal	$4.16
Qatar	$0.24
Romania	$2.72
Russia	$0.75
Rwanda	$2.57
Saudi Arabia	$0.25
Senegal	$1.50
Singapore	$4.67
South Africa	$2.62
South Korea	$3.78
Spain	$4.08
Sri Lanka	$1.58
Sudan	$0.58
Sweden	$4.55
Switzerland	$4.56
Taiwan	$2.95
Tanzania	$2.20
Thailand	$1.81
Tunisia	$0.68
Turkey	$3.12
UAE	$0.94
Uganda	$2.39
Ukraine	$2.04
United Kingdom	$4.25
United States	$2.36
Venezuela	$0.02
Vietnam	$1.57
Zambia	$2.57
Zimbabwe	$2.66
Grand Total	**$2.35**

